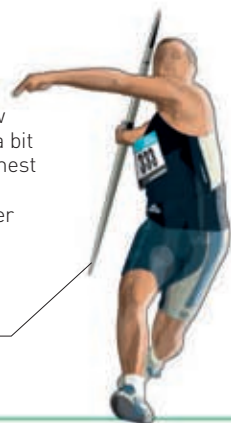


JAVELIN

Athletes compete to see who can throw the javelin (which is a bit like a spear) the furthest down the field. Men throw a slightly longer javelin than women.

Javelin



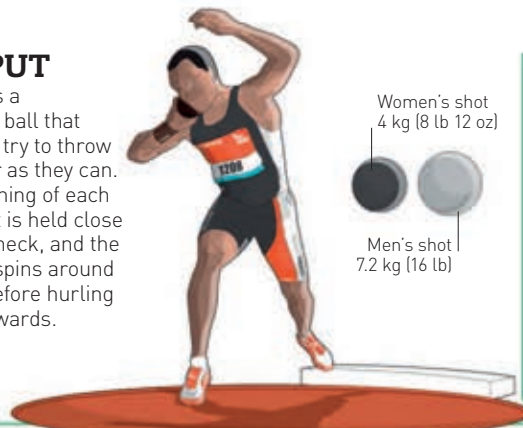
SHOT PUT

The "shot" is a heavy metal ball that competitors try to throw ("put") as far as they can. At the beginning of each put, the shot is held close against the neck, and the shot putter spins around in a circle before hurling the shot forwards.

Women's shot
4 kg (8 lb 12 oz)



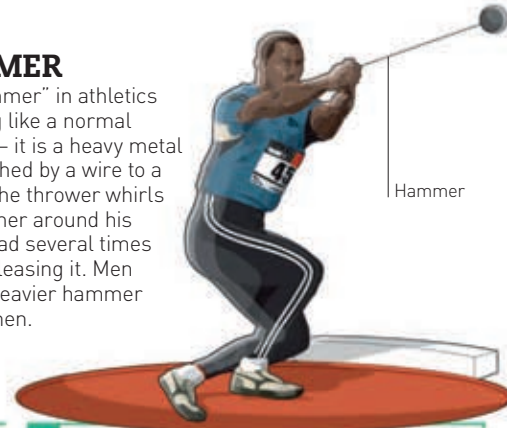
Men's shot
7.2 kg (16 lb)



HAMMER

The "hammer" in athletics is nothing like a normal hammer – it is a heavy metal ball attached by a wire to a handle. The thrower whirls the hammer around his or her head several times before releasing it. Men throw a heavier hammer than women.

Hammer



DISCUS

A discus is a fairly flat, heavy disc that spins through the air when it is thrown hard. The women's discus weighs 1 kg (2.2 lb) while the men's weighs 2 kg (4.4 lb). The winner is the person who throws it furthest.



1 PRELIMINARY SWING
Holding the discus in one hand, the athlete starts to swing it back and forwards.



2 TURNING CIRCLE
The athlete spins around one and a half times, gaining momentum.



3 RELEASE
At the front of the circle, the athlete sends the discus flying into the air.



4 FOLLOW-THROUGH
After releasing the discus, the athlete is careful to stay within the circle.

MIDDLE-DISTANCE RUNNING

These races are run over 800–3,000 m, and some, like the steeplechase, include hurdles and water jumps. The runners start off in lanes but do not usually have to stay in their lane throughout the race.



LONG-DISTANCE RUNNING

Races that are more than 3,000 m (3,280 yd) long are called "long-distance" races and demand great stamina. The events may take place in a stadium or along roads and paths. Many cities hold annual marathons, which are 42.2 km (26.2 miles) long.



MULTI-PART EVENTS

In these track and field events, competitors need to be all-round athletes with a combination of skills.

HEPTATHLON

This two-day competition for women includes seven events: 200 m, 100 m hurdles, high jump, shot put, long jump, javelin, and 800 m.

DECATHLON

Men compete in ten events in this two-day competition: 100 m, long jump, shot put, high jump, 400 m, 100 m hurdles, discus, pole vault, javelin, and 1,500 m.

DISTANCE EVENTS

There are eight Olympic middle- and long-distance events on the track. The 3,000 m steeplechase includes 35 jumps, seven of which are water jumps.

800 m	10,000 m
1,500 m	Marathon (42.4 km)
3,000 m Steeplechase	20 km walk
5,000 m	50 km walk (men only)

SPRINT EVENTS

In the Olympics, there are eight sprint events. Some include hurdles.

100 m	110 m hurdles (men only)
200 m	400 m hurdles
400 m	4 x 100 m relay
100 m hurdles (women only)	4 x 400 m relay

SPRINTING

These fast races are run over distances from 100–400 m. Sprinters push off from the blocks and hit top speed almost immediately.



RUNNING ALONE
Most races involve individual runners.



RUNNING A RELAY
Teams of four run one leg of the race each, passing on a baton.

HURDLES
Competitors have to jump hurdles while running.



WHEN USAIN BOLT BROKE THE 100 M WORLD RECORD IN 2009, HE COVERED AN ASTONISHING 12.2 M (40 FT) PER SECOND

SPRINT START

In short sprints, getting off to a clean, fast start can make the difference between winning and losing the race.



1 READY
The sprinter gets ready by crouching and setting both feet firmly against the blocks.

2 GET SET
The athlete's body raises into a bridge, with the hips raised above the shoulders.

3 GO!
On the starter's gun, the sprinter explodes out of the starting blocks.